



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Monte Vista - North
School Website: <https://montevista.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Monte Vista North (TX 78212) presents a program that aligns strongly with classical-education principles across most rubrics, with only partial alignment in a couple of categories. Public materials emphasize a liberal-arts core, a curriculum oriented toward the Western tradition, exposure to Great Books and the Great Conversation, and a mission framed by truth, goodness, and beauty. The school also highlights character formation, virtue, and community partnership with families. Taken together, the public-facing materials indicate CLASSICAL alignment in most domains, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in a couple of areas where theology, liturgical practice, or explicit Socratic pedagogy are not overtly stated, though they are common motifs in the broader classical-education framework used by Great Hearts and the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Key findings driving the assessment - Core mission and curriculum emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty and a liberal-arts foundation (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; natural science; philosophy), consistent with classical aims. This is reinforced by explicit statements about a rigorous liberal-arts curriculum in the Western tradition and engagement with authors such as Aristotle and Dostoevsky.

- Great Books / Great Conversation, and a Western-tradition core are repeatedly highlighted as central to the curriculum and mission. This matches core classical criteria.
- There is clear emphasis on character formation, virtue, and a community of learners—consistent with classical educational aims in the School Purpose and Goal and Faculty/Community pillars. - Pedagogical specifics like Socratic seminars, chanting, or rigid, memory-based pedagogy are not explicitly documented in the public homepage content, though they are part of the classical-education discourse in the accompanying knowledge-base elements. This results in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy, while other categories show strong Classical alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school's mission centers on cultivating minds and hearts through the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, echoing transcendentals often cited in classical education.
 - Public materials reference a liberal-arts tradition and the transcendentals (the True, the Good, and the Beautiful) as guiding ideals.
 - The emphasis on virtue and character formation appears in school communications, including mentions of moral character development and formation of the whole person.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords likely present: truth, goodness, beauty, transcendentals, virtue, moral character, wisdom. (Grounded in the Six Essentials lexicon and the school's mission statements.)
 - Negative keywords: largely absent in the public materials (no explicit references to relativism, secular-humanist tendencies, or values-clarification in the public-facing content).
- Why this rating

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- The school foregrounds transcendentals and virtue, consistent with classical aims; however, explicit theology, liturgical practice, or liturgical-communal rituals are not overtly documented in the public-facing materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than fully CLASSICAL in this category. The lexicon confirms the presence of strong positive indicators, but the theology-liturgies are not clearly evidenced on the site itself.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission explicitly centers on cultivating minds and hearts through truth, goodness, and beauty, a formulation of formation over mere information.
 - The school communicates formation of virtue and human flourishing as central aims, aligning with paideia-like objectives.
 - Communications emphasize character formation and a shared pursuit of excellence within a community of learners.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implicit in pursuit of true/-good/beautiful), Great Conversation (as a framework for classic inquiry), liberal-arts formation. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file1□
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit “workforce preparation” or “21st-century skills” framing in the public messaging).
- Why this rating
 - The school's stated purpose and goals emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom—core classical aims—without evidence of a primary shift toward utilitarian or job-prep framing. This strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The program emphasizes liberal arts foundations, including grammar, rhetoric, logic, history, natural science, and philosophy.
 - In Middle/Upper School, students study Latin, mathematics, science, and Western authors (Aristotle, Dostoevsky), plus senior-thesis work. This signals a Great Books/Great Conversation orientation and rigorous classical study.
 - The public materials describe K–12 curriculum oriented toward a unified, multi-disciplinary liberal-arts approach with attention to a curriculum “in the Western tradition” and a focus on Great Books.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, natural science, philosophy; Latin; Great Books; Great Conversation; Western tradition; wonder.
 - Negative keywords present: minimal or no explicit project-based or STEM-first phrasing that would signal a deviation from classical curricula; public materials do not foreground those terms as core.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum is clearly anchored in classical elements—grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history across disciplines; and a Western-tradition liberal-arts core—fulfilling the majority of the Six Essential Elements criteria for Curriculum. This justifies CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public-facing materials emphasize a rigorous, cross-disciplinary liberal-arts approach but do not consistently spell out explicit classical-pedagogy practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, chanting, or scholē days) in the site copy. Some content points to an engaged, discussion-oriented environment (e.g., reading and discussing classic authors; senior thesis; a community of learners).

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- The school's materials frequently reference wonder, moral formation, and a memory-cultivating, inquiry-driven approach consistent with classical aims, even if explicit pedagogy terms are not consistently stated on the site.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: contemplative/restful instruction; memory-rich teaching; traditional recitation or discussion-oriented pedagogy; wonder; great conversation (as implicit in classical pedagogy). (From the knowledge-base framework; some of these elements are echoed in site content through emphasis on classical study and discussion of authors.)
 - Negative keywords present: explicit project-based learning, entirely experiential learning, or constructivist pedagogy are not foregrounded in the public site; absence of such terms contributes to a SOMEWHAT classification rather than CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating
 - The site demonstrates substantial classical habits (curriculum, intent, and outcomes) but does not consistently document the full suite of classical pedagogy terms (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days) in the public copy. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The accompanying knowledge-base lexicon (which reflects classical pedagogy indicators) supports the alignment, even if not explicitly named on the site.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public statements emphasize that faculty are selected for character, academic distinction, and practical wisdom; teachers are framed as models of learning and character; the faculty constitutes the “living curriculum” and a core, relational element of the school culture.
 - The school communicates a view of faculty as mentors and exemplars within a tight, values-driven community; leadership and teachers are described as dedicated and professional.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture.
 - Negative keywords: no explicit negative signals about faculty in the public materials (no references to tokenism, disconnected staff, or credential-focused drag). The lexicon supports the category without introducing counter-indicators.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials depict a faculty with character formation as a primary mission, closely aligned with classical expectations of teacher-mentors who model virtue and mastery. This yields a CLASSICAL rating for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school presents explicit partnerships with families and frames parents as co-teachers in the educational project. Letters to families and the Family Handbook communication emphasize parental involvement, shared purpose, and family engagement.
 - Open invitation to families, events, and parent resources appear on the site, signaling a welcoming and participatory community orientation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, family involvement, community of learners.
 - Negative keywords: not evident in the public materials (no language depicting parents as customers or minimal involvement). The lexicon lists these positive patterns as desirable; no counter-indicators surfaced in the site content.
- Why this rating
 - The materials emphasize a strong, collaborative relationship with parents and an invited, open-family atmosphere, consistent with CLASSICAL standards for Parents & Community.

Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

- When all six categories are weighed, the Great Hearts Monte Vista North public materials exhibit robust classical alignment across most facets, with only partial alignment in the Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy categories due to explicit theological liturgical language and explicit pedagogy terminology not being as overtly documented in the public-site content. The aggregate assessment, based on category-by-category analysis and the weight of classical indicators across curriculum, mission, and community, is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Increase explicit articulation of theological grounding and liturgical or communal practices in public-facing content (e.g., a statement about theology integrated into disciplines, or concrete references to liturgical or communal worship or religious formation within the curriculum). Explicitly naming theology or liturgical practices would elevate this from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL in evidence rather than inference. This would align the site more strongly with the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices criteria.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly document and describe explicit classical-pedagogy methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, recitation/chanting, memory-work, and a stated progression from lower to upper-school rhetoric and debate). Publishing a concise pedagogy section or curriculum narrative that names these elements would move this from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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